

User Stories For Features:

1. **Login & Logout:** Login should be prompted upon reaching the site/opening the app. I think a token system while the user is logged in should also be implemented. Logout should be easily accessible at all times. Account creation should be available on the login page to allow new users to easily create an account. Accounts should retain all information related to that account. Passwords should be encrypted. Accounts should persist after application closure. Accounts should have a manage/settings feature to allow for preferences to be saved.
2. **Daily Emotional Check-In:** When accessing the Pond page/tab the user should be prompted for their daily check-in if they haven't checked in for that day. The user would be prompted with an emotion wheel to help them decide. They should be able to select up to three emotions, but only be required to select one to complete the check-in. This will be split into primary, secondary, and tertiary emotions. There should also be an optional message to send to their PondMate. This message will be displayed first upon the other user (PondMate) entering the pond (viewing the pond page/tab) and before the check-in occurs, or if the check-in has been completed, before being able to view the pond (could be a pop-up).
3. **Daily Relationship-Oriented Discussion:** This should be an optional discussion PondMates are allowed to participate in. It should appear as a question above the pond. PondaMates should be able to select it and post their reply. Responses should be saved to be viewed later, but only saved if there was a response, and persist after application closure. Discussion question will be generated by AI and adjusted based on feedback after the question and overall participation in the question. More on the AI feature.
4. **Reminder Space:** There should be a tab for reminders from the other PondMate. It should have an option to acknowledge the reminder with an emoji (heart, thumbs-up, etc.). It should also have a type. Is it a statement or a task? If it is a task, the other pondmate should be able to select it for completion or rejection. Reminders will clear upon completion or rejection of tasks, and upon acknowledgement of statements (we can call them ribbits). The other PondMater should be able to view the acknowledgement emoji and completion or rejection, then have the option to clear it. The requestee should have the option to cancel/delete tasks or statements.
5. **Bug-Themed Gift System:** Each user should have a "stash of bugs" that is tracked by the system. A bug will be rewarded to each user upon both users completing their daily check-in. The bugs can be used to feed the other frog, and the user should be able to see that the frog was fed.
6. **Frog Reactivity and Emotional Reflection:** Frogs should appear on the pong screen (left and right). The frog should reflect the emotional state from the selected emotion on the emotion wheel from the daily check-in. The frog should appear asleep if the check-in hasn't been completed. The frog should display a heart upon receiving a "fed by PondMate" notification. Frogs should have a chat bubble with three dots above their head if there is an unacknowledged reminder from the other user. Frogs reset to a sleep state every day. Frogs should be able to be named.

7. **Smart Connection Assistant:** There should be an integrated AI feature that helps users connect in small, low-pressure ways. The AI should use simple relationship context, such as the user's current mood, their PondMate's current mood, recent check-ins, unanswered reminders, and recent discussion activity. Based on this context, it should generate gentle suggestions such as one care action, one possible message to send, or one light daily discussion prompt. The AI should not make decisions for the user or pressure either person to act. Instead, it should function as optional support for users who want help knowing what to say, how to respond, or how to show care when their partner may be tired, frustrated, overwhelmed, happy, or in need of encouragement. The user should be able to accept, ignore, or regenerate suggestions.